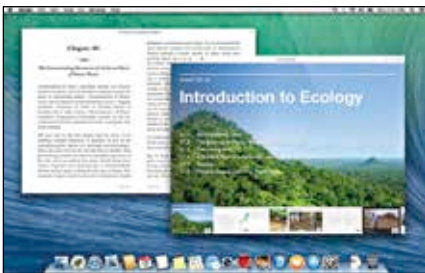


prise Linux, CentOS, OpenSuse, Arch Linux, Gentoo. These distributions usually include the Linux kernel, supporting utilities and libraries and additional application software. Most of these distros come equipped with a GUI usually GNOME or KDE. Linux was never meant to be a desktop operating system, initially it only found usage on servers. A lot of work has gone into improving the turnaround time for improved I/O performance. Projects like upstart and systemd are being actively developed to improve the boot time.

Most of the popular applications out there are now available for Linux like Mozilla Firefox, LibreOffice, Blender, Chromium, Adobe Reader to name a few. Increasing number of proprietary desktop applications are also being ported to Linux. For example nearly all high end animation and visual effects software such as Autodesk Maya, Softimage XSI and Apple Shake are available for Linux. Linux now is also able to run Steam and Desura, which are video game distribution platforms. Apart from these two a lot of companies are actively porting video games to Linux.

Mac OS X

Mac OS X has remain nearly unchanged from it's introduction with Cheetah to the upcoming Mavericks. It is built on top of the Darwin foundation which was adapted from NextStep OS which was developed by Steve Jobs and his team during his stint at NeXT. iOS, the operating system which powers the iPhone, iPad and iPod are all powered by the same foundation. They



Mac OS X Mavericks

share a lot of frameworks and libraries which makes development on both these systems very easy.

Mac OS X has built for itself a host of interesting features like Automator, for creating automatic workflows of task, Boot Camp which makes installing other operating systems like Win-

dows 7 or 8 a breeze and Time Machine, an automated backup utility. These are in addition to a brilliant set of tools that Mac OS X makes available out of the box – Safari, the WebKit powered default web browser; iPhoto, a photo management application much like Picasa; iMovie, a simple video